

What it costs to take the website live

A plain breakdown of the real costs involved once we're ready to put the site on the real internet, so there are no surprises. Right now the site runs only on my own computer for building and testing, nothing here has been bought yet.

The essentials

These are the things the site genuinely cannot go live without. Prices are in US dollars, since that is how these services bill no matter where you are.

Item	What it's actually for	Typical cost	How often
Domain name	The web address itself, e.g. pbsprojects.com or pbsprojects.co.zw, what customers type or find through search.	Roughly \$6-\$15 a year for .co.zw, or about \$10-\$14 a year for .com	Yearly renewal. If it lapses, the address goes offline.
Hosting	The server that actually runs the site and the admin panel, and keeps them reachable at all times, not just on my computer.	Roughly \$5-\$25 a month depending on how much traffic the site gets	Monthly
Database hosting	Where real data lives, quote requests, projects, testimonials. Sometimes bundled into the hosting cost above, sometimes separate.	Roughly \$0-\$19 a month, often included with hosting	Monthly
Photo and video storage	Where uploaded jobsite photos and videos actually live and get served from.	Free to start, only becomes a paid cost once the gallery grows a lot	Monthly, only once it grows

Not a real cost

The security certificate that makes the site show a secure padlock (https) is free, every real hosting option includes this automatically. The WhatsApp button and chat links on the site are also free, they just open a normal WhatsApp chat, there is no paid WhatsApp service involved.

Optional, worth knowing about

Item	What it's actually for	Typical cost	How often
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A real business email	An address like info@pbsprojects.com instead of a personal Gmail, more professional for quotes and replies.	Roughly \$7-\$8.50 per person per month	Monthly, entirely optional
Future changes or new features	Any work after the site is live, new sections, fixes, changes.	Not a fixed subscription, we would agree on this directly when it comes up	As needed

The realistic bottom line

Going with the simplest, cheapest real setup: roughly **\$10-\$30 a month** for hosting and storage, plus a **one-time yearly domain fee of about \$6-\$15**. The business email is the only genuinely optional add-on on top of that. Nothing here needs to be decided now, this is just so the real numbers are on the table before we get to that point.

Prepared by Denzel for Panashe Simbi and Herbert Matembunze. Figures are current researched estimates as of July 2026 and will shift over time, we'll confirm exact numbers together before anything is actually purchased.